

semitones in an **octave**, as opposed to **diatonic**, based on a scale of seven notes.

Classical

Music composed between 1750 and 1830; describes pieces from the period after the **Baroque**.

concerto

A large piece for solo instrument and orchestra, designed to showcase the soloist's skills; the **Baroque** concerto grosso, however, has a more equal interplay between the smaller orchestra (ripieno) and a group of soloists (concertino).

concerto grosso

See concerto.

consort

An instrumental ensemble popular during the 16th and 17th centuries in England; also used to describe the music played by these ensembles as well as the performance itself.

contralto

A term describing the lowest of the female voices (**alto**) in an **opera** context.

contrapuntal